Diclofenac (Voltaren)

Scope of Practice	EMT-A
Classification	• Non-Steroidal Anti-inflammatory (NSAID)
Usual Presentation	• 75mg/3ml ampule
Mechanism of Action	• Inhibits cyclooxygenase (COX-1 and COX-2) enzymes, which stops the production of prostaglandins causing a reduction in pain, inflammation, and fever.
Indications	• Moderate to Severe Pain
Contraindications	• Known allergy • Previous reaction to NSAIDS • Renal insufficiency • Pregnancy
Precautions	• Asthma/COPD (history of a previous worsening of asthma or COPD after NSAID administration).
Side Effects	• Pain at injection site
Adult Dose & Administration	• 75mg IM (into a large muscle) • 75mg IV (diluted into 100ml normal saline, administered over 10minutes)
Pediatric Dose & Administration	• Not to be administered to pediatrics
Use in Pregnancy and Lactation	• Pregnancy: Fetal harm has been demonstrated. Diclofenac should not be administered. • Lactation: Safety has not been established. If essential to be administered, the mother should be advised to stop breast feeding until advised by their physician.
Additional Information	• Intravenous administration should be avoided due to an increased risk of thromboembolic events.